

Adam Kliegman

Software Engineer - Design Systems • Frontend Architecture • Accessibility • AI Products

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Summary

Frontend-leaning and design-systems leaning fullstack engineer with more than 13 years of experience building user-facing products across education, AI, FinTech, MarTech, and eCommerce at scale. Founded and scaled a design system to full adoption across a 50-engineer organization, halving redundant UI code. Sets technical direction for frontend architecture, design systems, and accessibility across teams, turning ambiguous product problems into durable systems other engineers build on. Leads through standards, documentation, migration strategy, and mentorship as much as through code, with prior experience in product leadership, design, and psychology.

Experience

MagicSchool AI • EdTech • 8M+ active users • \$45M Series B • B2B/B2C

Senior Software Engineer • Jan 2025 to Present

- Founded the design system - own frontend architecture for an AI-native platform serving more than 8 million educators, driving the system to 100% adoption across a 50-engineer organization while cutting redundant UI code by half.
- Lead the cross-functional design-system guild, defining governance, contribution model, adoption strategy, documentation standards, and long-term roadmap for engineers and designers company-wide.
- Architect and evolve the design system end to end: reusable components, semantic tokens, layout primitives, interaction patterns, information architecture, implementation guidance, testing strategy, and contribution standards.
- Led the migration off a fragmented Material UI codebase onto a single React and TypeScript foundation of ShadCN, Radix UI, Tailwind CSS 4, Wedges, and Storybook, retiring the legacy stack entirely without pausing feature delivery.
- Build AI product surfaces end to end, including streaming model responses, structured outputs validated against schema, retry and fallback paths, and human-in-the-loop review so educators steer generation rather than accept it.
- Deliver a WYSIWYG quiz builder that lets educators generate, edit, reorder, validate, and refine AI-produced assessment content within a single editing surface.
- Define and enforce frontend standards for accessibility, component design, semantic HTML, keyboard navigation, focus management, testing, performance, and maintainability, and uphold them through design and code review.
- Drive application-wide accessibility remediation producing an exceptional VPAT assessment with minimal outstanding findings.
- Partner with product, design, curriculum, AI, backend, and quality teams to turn ambiguous ideas into coherent, user-centered experiences, and mentor engineers on component design, accessibility, and system thinking.

Technology: TypeScript, React, Next.js, Vercel, Supabase, ShadCN, Radix UI, Tailwind CSS, Storybook, Vitest, Playwright, PostgreSQL, Vercel AI SDK, Anthropic and OpenAI APIs, Streaming UI, Structured Outputs, Evals

RubyLaw • 20 of the 50 Largest U.S. Law Firms • Legal MarTech SaaS • B2B2C

Software Engineer III • Jul 2023 to Jul 2024

- Engineered a Figma-based design system, reusable React component library, starter toolkit, document-generation system, and content-management integrations for the platform's law-firm clients.
- Built configurable, polished, and WCAG-compliant websites, blogs, intranets, and extranets using a shared component architecture.
- Translated sophisticated brand systems into reusable component APIs without sacrificing responsive behavior, accessibility, performance, or visual quality.

Technology: JavaScript, React, Sass, CSS Modules, Storybook, Express, Node.js, Elasticsearch, Puppeteer

Demyst Data • FinTech SaaS • Acquired by Feedzai (2025) • B2B

Director of Product Management • Mar 2021 to Jan 2023

Senior Product Manager • Oct 2019 to Mar 2021

- Led the transformation of Demyst into an API-first SaaS platform focused on self-service data discovery, integration, and management.
- Architected and personally engineered the customer platform frontend while managing a globally distributed team of eight.
- Built an atomic design system used across the company's products, improving interface consistency, accessibility, and engineering velocity.
- Defined frontend architecture, information hierarchy, interaction patterns, and complex enterprise data-management experiences.
- Led engineering for a company-wide rebrand and marketing-site rebuild that increased daily impressions by approximately 6,000 and doubled the inbound lead pipeline.
- Bridged product strategy, UX, frontend engineering, data science, and backend development to turn technically complex workflows into understandable user experiences.

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Technology: JavaScript, React, Redux, LESS, Zeplin, Ruby on Rails, Python, Sklearn, REST, PostgreSQL, Jest

Noodle • EdTech • Founded by John Katzman (Princeton Review, 2U) • B2B2C/B2C

Sr. Product Manager • Feb 2018 to Mar 2019

Lead Product Engineer • Jan 2016 to Feb 2018

UX/UI Engineer • Oct 2014 to Jan 2016

- Designed and engineered an end-to-end tutoring marketplace and operations platform spanning discovery, enrollment, scheduling, instruction, communication, and administration.
- Helped double year-over-year revenue to more than \$2 million, grow monthly traffic by approximately 5,000 visitors, and reduce the average sales cycle by half.
- Built online-learning products integrating with university systems, virtual instruction tools, an interactive whiteboard, and a custom learning-management platform.
- Translated the needs of students, educators, families, and internal teams into intuitive workflows and practical technical solutions.

Technology: JavaScript, Flask/Jinja, Sass, MySQL, Firebase, REST, jQuery

Earlier Experience

Shoplet • eCommerce • \$50M Annual Revenue • B2C

Frontend Developer • 2013 to 2014

- Led UI implementation for a brand refresh and developed eCommerce experiences supporting approximately 20,000 daily visitors.

Tigerspike • Mobile App Development • Acquired by Concentrix (2017) • Agency

Business Analyst • 2012 to 2013

- Supported technical product strategy and enterprise solution development for Fortune 100 clients, helping secure more than \$5 million in new business.

Technical Skills

Languages and Frontend: TypeScript, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, React, Next.js, React Server Components, Suspense, Redux, Zustand, TanStack Query, Zod, React Aria, ShadCN, Radix UI, Material UI, Tailwind CSS, CSS Modules, Sass

Design Systems and UX: Component Architecture, Component APIs, Design Tokens, Style Dictionary, Theming and Multi-Brand Support, Storybook, Visual Regression Testing, Figma, Atomic Design, Responsive Design, Interaction Design, Information Architecture, WYSIWYG Interfaces

AI Engineering: LLM Application Development, Anthropic and OpenAI APIs, Vercel AI SDK, Streaming Responses, Structured Outputs and JSON Schema, Tool and Function Calling, Prompt Engineering, Retrieval-Augmented Generation, Evals, Guardrails and Content Safety, Human-in-the-Loop Workflows, MCP, Claude Code

Accessibility and Quality: WCAG 2.2 AA, Section 508, VPAT, Semantic HTML, ARIA, Keyboard Navigation, Focus Management, Screen-Reader Support, axe-core, Vitest, React Testing Library, Jest, Playwright, Cypress, Lighthouse, Core Web Vitals

Backend and Platform: Node.js, Express, REST APIs, GraphQL, Webhooks, Edge and Serverless Functions, PostgreSQL, Supabase, Row-Level Security, MySQL, Redis, Elasticsearch, Django, Flask, Ruby on Rails, Vercel, AWS

Developer Experience and Architecture: Monorepos, Turborepo, pnpm, Changesets, Feature Flags, Incremental Migration, Trunk-Based Development, CI/CD, GitHub Actions, ESLint, Vite, Webpack, Sentry, Technical Standards and RFCs

Education

Silicon Valley Product Group

Product Leaders Academy • 2020

University of Wisconsin–Madison

B.S. in Psychology